

Shark types

There are many different types of sharks. Some look very different to the common torpedo shape.



Leopard shark: it has golden spotted skin that camouflages it well.



Saw shark: its long nose has razor-sharp teeth down it, like a saw.



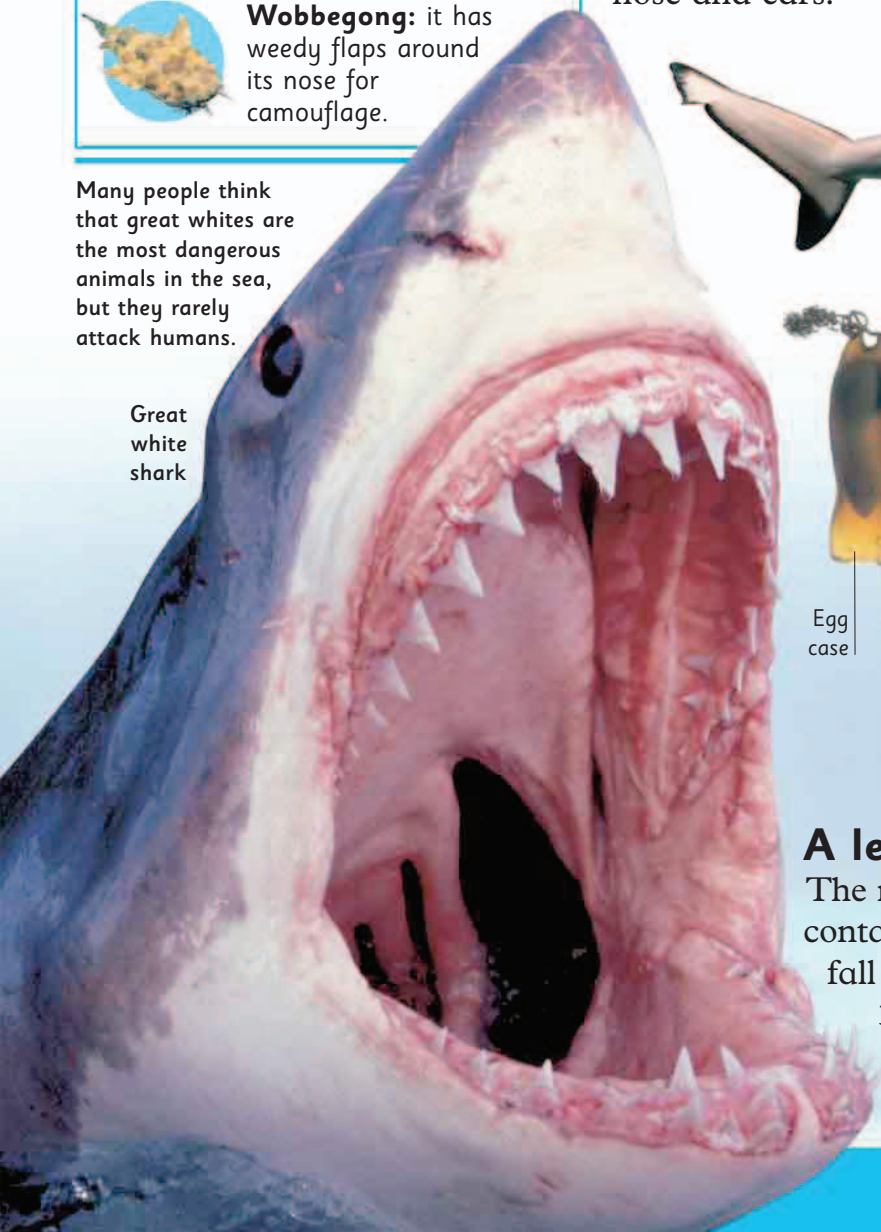
Hammerhead: this shark has a rectangular head with eyes at each end.



Wobbegong: it has weedy flaps around its nose for camouflage.

Many people think that great whites are the most dangerous animals in the sea, but they rarely attack humans.

Great white shark



Sharks and rays

A shark's fin poking out of the water is enough to send a chill down your spine. But they also fill fish with fear – sharks are the largest and most successful meat-eaters in the sea.

Bendy bones

Sharks and rays do not have bones. Instead their skeleton is made of soft, bendy cartilage – the same stuff that's in your nose and ears.



Black-tipped reef shark

Born in a purse

Some sharks start life as a tiny adult in an egg case, which looks a bit like a handbag. This case is attached to seaweed and the baby shark grows inside for about six to nine months.



Empty egg cases are known as mermaid's purses.

A lethal smile

The massive jaws of the great white shark contain a terrifying set of sharp teeth, which often fall out as they tear flesh. A shark may lose 30,000 teeth in a lifetime. They are, however, always replaced with new sharp ones.

What is the largest fish in the world?